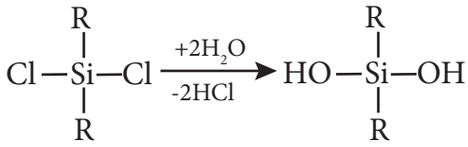
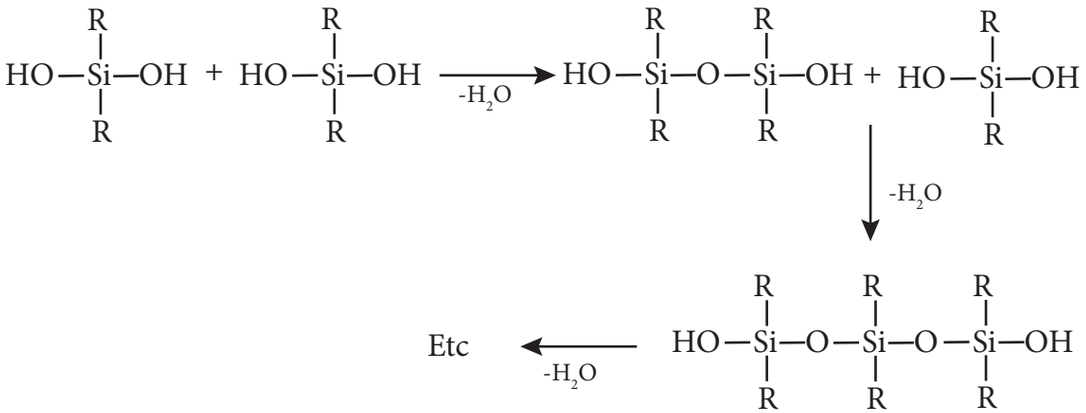
Preparation:

Generally silicones are prepared by the hydrolysis of dialkyldichlorosilanes (R_2SiCl_2) or diaryldichlorosilanes Ar_2SiCl_2, which are prepared by passing vapours of RCl or ArCl over silicon at 570 K with copper as a catalyst.

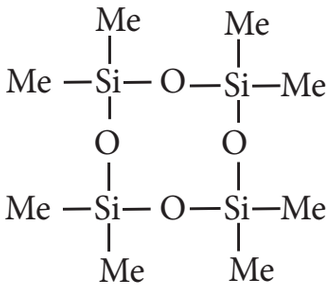
$$2RCl + Si \xrightarrow{Cu\ /\ 570\ K} R_2SiCl_2$$

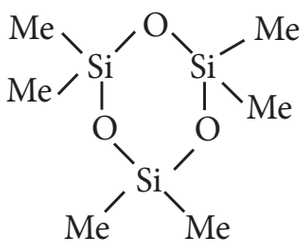
The hydrolysis of dialkylchloro silanes R_2SiCl_2 yields to a straight chain polymer which grown from both the sides

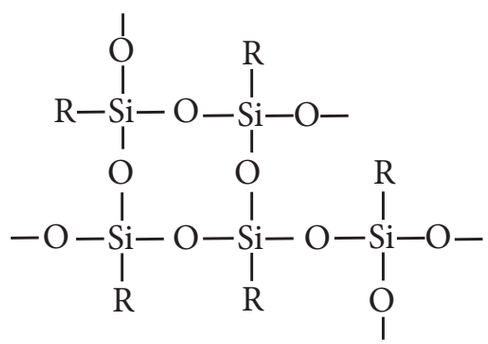




The hydrolysis of monoalkylchloro silanes $RSiCl_3$ yields to a very complex cross linked polymer.. Linear silicones can be converted into cyclic or ring silicones when water molecules is removed from the terminal –OH groups.







Types of silicones:

(i) Linear silicones:

They are obtained by the hydrolysis and subsequent condensation of dialkyl or diaryl silicon chlorides.

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